

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

PET (FDG) for Breast Cancer

220.6.10

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

220.6.10

Manual Section Title

PET (FDG) for Breast Cancer

Version Number**Effective Date of this Version**

01/28/2005

Ending Effective Date of this Version

04/03/2009

Implementation Date

04/18/2005

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Effective for services performed on or after October 1, 2002, Medicare covers FDG PET only as an adjunct to other imaging modalities for: (1) staging breast cancer patients with distant

metastasis, (2) restaging patients with loco-regional recurrence or metastasis, or (3) monitoring tumor response to treatment for women with locally advanced and metastatic breast cancer when a change in therapy is contemplated.

Limitations: Medicare continues to nationally non-cover initial diagnosis of breast cancer and staging of axillary lymph nodes.

Documentation that these conditions are met should be maintained by the referring physician in the beneficiary's medical record, as is normal business practice.

(This NCD last reviewed September 2002.)

Cross Reference

See NCD for [PET Scans](#) (§220.6).

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 527 \(Medicare Claims Processing Manual\)](#)

[TN 956 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

[TN 1817 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

[TN 1833 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

31

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R31NCD.pdf>

Revision History

04/2005 - Removed text from [PET Scans NCD](#) (§220.6) and created a separate NCD. Effective date 01/28/05. Implementation date 04/18/05. ([TN 31](#)) (CR 3741)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Positron Emission Tomography \(FDG\) for Breast Cancer \(CAG-00094N\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
FDG PET for Breast Cancer (Replaced with Section 220.6.17) - RETIRED	3	04/10/2023 - N/A	View
FDG PET for Breast Cancer (Replaced with Section 220.6.17)	2	04/03/2009 - 04/10/2023	View
PET (FDG) for Breast Cancer	1	01/28/2005 - 04/03/2009	You are here